



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2023-24
MONDAY TEST

CLASS: VIII
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I

FULL MARKS: 40
DATE: 12.06.23

General Instructions:

- The question paper consists of three printed pages.
- Answers should be to the point.
- Copy the question numbers carefully before answering the questions.
- Marks will be deducted for spelling errors.

SECTION A

I. Choose the most appropriate option and write it down in the answer sheet with the correct number:

[10]

- a. The teacher asked me to _____ my answer script before submitting it.
i. pull up ii. run through iii. see into iv. turn up
- b. The old man claimed that he could _____ the future of people by reading their palms.
i. see into ii. put in iii. cast down iv. set apart
- c. India _____ all diplomatic ties with Morocco over political disagreement.
i. laid down ii. held up iii. broke off iv. kept in
- d. These official reports _____ the true picture of the country's economic condition.
i. set apart ii. work up iii. speak of iv. run into
- e. Ever since the man heard about the losses his company has incurred, he has been _____.
i. cast down ii. done up iii. taken to iv. kept in
- f. Take an umbrella _____ you should get drenched in the shower.
i. if ii. lest iii. for iv. unless
- g. She does not want a promotion _____ does she want an increment in her salary.
i. or ii. but iii. nor iv. and

- h. _____ you speak up, we can't hear you.
i. If ii. Although iii. Until iv. Unless
- i. She browsed through the magazine _____ I got ready.
i. when ii. so iii. while iv. because
- j. They were hungry _____ they did not stop at the restaurant.
i. since ii. yet iii. so iv. and

SECTION B

II. Join the following sentences without using *and*, *but* or *so*: [5]

- a) He was my childhood friend. He deceived me.
- b) I pressed the button. Water gushed out of the tap at once.
- c) The sun went down. A cool wind began to blow.
- d) He is not lazy. He is not careless.
- e) He was given a merit certificate. He was given a handsome scholarship.

III. Rewrite the sentences with the correct phrasal verbs: [5]

- a) The man had taken to some money for his old age.
- b) Due to the heat wave, the children had to be held up inside the classrooms during the break.
- c) We were shocked to see our neighbour's pet dog work up at our doorstep injured.
- d) Ananya pulled up a shrill cry when the needle was pricked in her arm.
- e) He could not turn down his emotions as his eyes turned wet after giving his farewell speech.

IV. Read the passage and answer the questions that follow:

Muthachi made a living by selling gram flour savouries, which she prepared herself. With this, the penniless old woman was barely able to manage a living. She had arranged to give her daughter in marriage to Madasami, a casual labourer. The marriage was to take place the next morning.

At five-thirty on the eve of the marriage, Muthachi was sitting in the house of the goldsmith. She was in a hurry to go back home before the nightfall as she had to travel through a lonely forest.

Muthachi was becoming anxious about the new earrings. The goldsmith said that he was working hard to finish the job. As he was giving it a finishing touch, Muthachi got to know from the goldsmith about Chettiar, a pawnbroker who was stopped near Mallaperambu and robbed of his money tied around his waist.

"And who was it that perpetrated all these atrocities and escaped?" enquired the old woman.

"Oh, who else but that Sangu Thevan."

"May the Lord of the Bamboo Reed protect me! Well, have you finished?"

“Just a minute. A little finishing here and it is done,” said the goldsmith, and presently he wrapped the pair of earrings in a piece of red tissue paper and handed them over to the old woman.

The hour of twilight soon passed and night came swiftly. Muthachi was hurrying through a forest. Soon it grew darker and darker till “one couldn’t see the palm of one’s own hand”, as the old woman said. Muthachi had never been afraid. But today, she seemed to see a Sangu Thevan behind every tree; on every branch, ready to pounce on her.

Suddenly, she saw a dark figure disappear behind a tree ahead of her in the same direction in which she was going. Apprehending danger, she started praying in her mind to the Lord of the Bamboo Reed. Muthachi went forward and in a raised voice asked the person to come out. As she stepped forward, she could see a man come out. He was in a big turban having long side-whiskers, his short dhoti tied tightly around his sturdy waist.

“Look here, old woman; where are you going in this pitch-dark night?” asked the stranger.

“Tomorrow is my daughter’s wedding. I have to reach home and get everything ready. I have obtained on hire a pair of earrings. Even the poor must try to impress people with such things.” Hearing this, the man told her that he would accompany her a distance. The man repeatedly glanced at the old woman as he continued on his way, lost in his own thoughts.

A little later the woman said, “At last! There I see the temple. Now I can go home by myself.”

Turning around Muthachi said, “What is your name, you kind man?”

“Sangu Thevan,” came the reply.

He took out a bag and gave it to the old woman. “Take these gold coins; it is a present to your daughter. Let your first grandson bear my name.”

The bag of gold coins fell from Muthachi’s hand and she whispered in terror, “Spare me.”

“Don’t be afraid. No harm will come to you.” And the man picked up the bag, put it back into her hand. The old woman, too frightened to speak hurried away, only turning to look at him again and again.

Sangu Thevan sat down on a rock nearby, and chuckled to himself.

- a) Give the meaning of the following words or phrases as used in the passage. One word answer or short phrases will be accepted. [3]
- i) perpetrated
 - ii) pounce
 - iii) sturdy
- b) Answer the following questions briefly in your own words.
- i) Why did Muthachi go to the goldsmith? Why was she anxious to go home? [2]
 - ii) How do we know that Muthachi was a very poor woman? [1]
 - iii) Why did Muthachi see ‘a Sangu Thevan behind every tree’? [2]
 - iv) Describe Sangu Thevan. [2]
 - v) Why do you think the bag of gold coins fell from Muthachi’s hands? [2]
- c) In not more than 50 words, write how Muthachi happened to meet Sangu Thevan in the forest. [8]